

# Sh'ma Yisrael

54b

Version 2

Salomon Sulzer  
Arr. Stuart Izon

*Whilst Sulzer's melody is fairly ubiquitous today, I'd hazard that no one today sings this exactly in the way he wrote it. His score for Sh'ma Yisrael contains four separate melodies, which I will label A, B, C, and D. As discussed above, the congregational responses (B and D) come from an earlier, traditional setting, where B is fairly obscure. Sulzer's melody for Echad (C) is well known to us, and sounds suspiciously similar to his Ki Mitzion. However, his tune for the chazzan's exposition of Sh'ma (A) is different, and I have personally never heard this sung in any synagogue. Instead, chazzanim apply his Echad melody (C) back to Sh'ma. This practice can already be seen in several scores from the mid 19th century, hence I have similarly excluded it in this arrangement. Ironically, many congregations who use this melody (C) for Sh'ma, eschew it for Echad, preferring the traditional melody (D).*

*Outside of the congregations which don't use Sulzer's melody at all, I typically hear the following combinations being used today: CCDD, CDCD and CCCD (which is most unsatisfyingly asymmetric). To inevitably please no one, this arrangement utilises CBCD.*

Chazzan

*f* Sh'-ma yis-ra-el a-do-nai e-lo-hei-nu a-do-nai e-chad

8

M  
A

*f* Sh' - ma yis-ra - el a - do - nai e - lo - hei - nu a - do - nai e - chad

T  
B

15

C.

E - chad e - lo - hei - nu ga - dol a - do - nei - nu ka - dosh sh' - mo

22

M  
A

E - chad e - lo - hei - nu ga - dol a - do - nei - nu ka - dosh sh' - mo

T  
B